Checkpoint Presentation: Group 1

Homa - Design Coordinator

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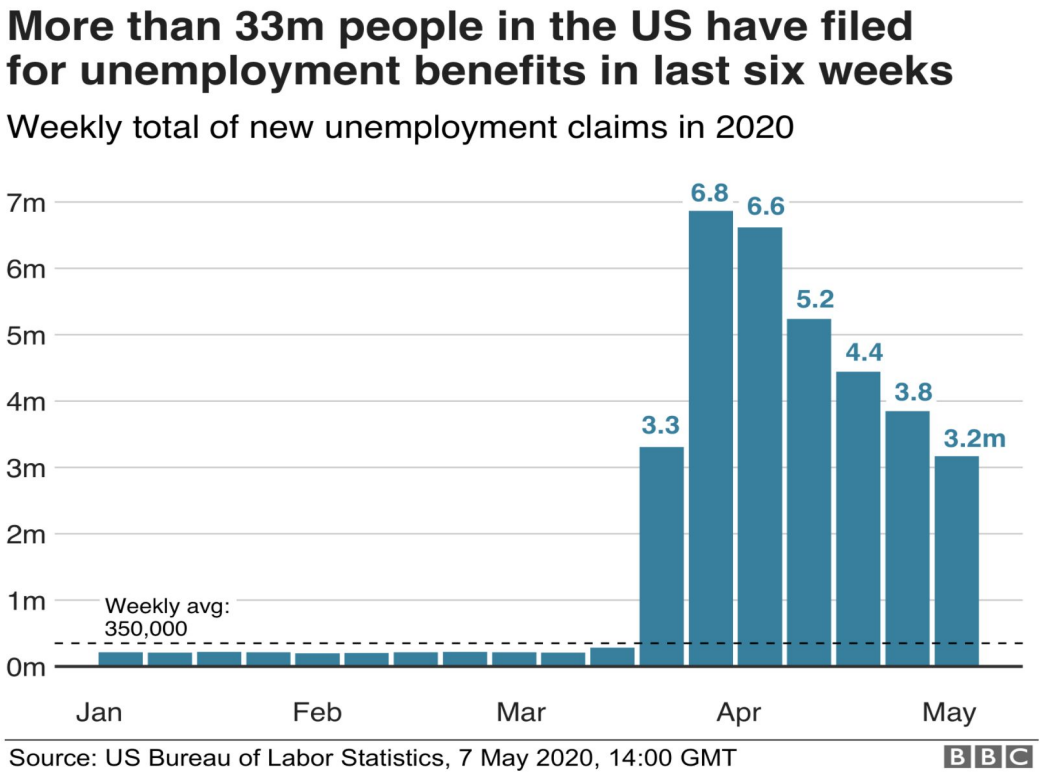
Literature Review/ Competitive Analysis

- US unemployment rate **increased to 14.6% in May 2020 from 3.5% in February 2020**, seeing the sharpest increase since the Great Depression in 1930s
- More than **35 million people** in the US filed for unemployment from **March 24, 2020 to May 14, 2020**



Coronavirus: Pandemic sends US jobless rate to 14.7%. (2020, May 8). Retrieved November 13, 2020, from https://www.bbc.com/news/business-52591262

Literature Review/ Competitive Analysis

- An EPI survey of 24,607 participants found that **for every 10 people** who have **successfully filed unemployment claims**, **3 or 4 people** have been **unable to register** and another **2 people have not tried to apply**
- The survey indicates that an additional **8.9 million to 13.9 million people** have been **shut out of the system**
- Idled workers are encountering downed websites and clogged phone lines, due the state governments being overwhelmed by applicants.
- **9.4%** of poll respondents said they had **successfully applied for unemployment benefits**, while **3.4%** said they tried but **could not get through**. A further **1.9%** said they **did not apply** because the **process was too difficult.**
- Many Americans who managed to file claims have **yet to receive payments** weeks after they lost their jobs.
- Labor Department statistics show that **71% who apply are getting payments**, although that figure varies significantly by state.

Sullivan, A. (2020, April 28). Millions of Americans locked out of unemployment system, survey finds. Retrieved November 13, 2020, from

https://www.reuters.com/article/us-health-coronavirus-usa-unemployment-idUSKCN22A1MR

User Research

~30 min Interviews

- **Semi - structured**
  - Bank of questions to refer to:
    - Background
      - Where are you from?
      - How old are you?
      - What did you major in? What is your job?
      - How often do you use technology?
    - Unemployment Questions
      - Can you tell me a bit about how you became unemployed?
      - Can you walk me through the process you took to apply for unemployment benefits?
      - How did you feel throughout this process?

- **Contextual**
  - Have you seen this form before?
  - If yes, was it helpful in determining whether you were eligible?
    - What was your experience like answering the questions?
  - If no, did you know the form existed?
    - Looking at the questions now, do you think it would have been helpful?
    - Would you need any additional information or help to answer the questions?

User Research

~30 min Interviews

User 1

23 years old
From: Issaquah
About:

Student and Part-time UW Student
Furloughed at the beginning of COVID-19

User 2
46 years old
From: Japan
About :

Aquatic Therapy Lead
Her entire department Seattle Children's Hospital was furloughed

User 3

22 years old
From: India

Undergraduate student studying Computer Science
Was working for healthcare company intending to finish work in September

Affinity Diagram

Before Applying

- unsure if eligible
- Didn't know eligibility checker existed
- Worried if she worked enough hours to be eligible
- Worried about no income
- Main source of information from coworkers
- unsure where to check eligibility
- cluttered website
- Overwhelemd

While Applying

- Unclear/ambiguous vocabulary
- Embedded questions with different answers to each
- Not accessible in other languages
- Trying to interpret how to best answer questions to make the process easier/get payments quicker
- No live support
  - asking native english speakers for help
- taking a long time to apply (2 hours)
- phone line wont pick up
  - Had to call 163 times to get through
- can't exit out & return
- Website keeps crashing

After Applying

- Unclear when results would be coming
- Answered question wrong causing to take even logner
- Takes too long to find out results
- Impatient
- seems intentionally confusing
- Questions' language intentionally discouraging
- Froze the application, asking to return the money she received
- Try to decide how else to get income in meantime
- Even after using eligibility checker, still unsure whether eligible
  - inaccessible to part time/ non traditional workers

Brainstorming

- Questions appear one at a time (less overwhelming)
- Clear feedback
- translations other than spanish
- 24/7 chat support
- Language translation
- Estimated time to completion
  - able to save & return to application
- simple eligibility check
- Faster turn around time for applications
- FAQ for confusing questions
- Screen reader to make it accessible
  - Make the form interactive instead of PDF

Personas

Jess

23 | Seattle, WA

Student

· STATUS

Single

No Children

· SALARY

$20/hr

PERSONALITY

Technology- friendly

Unemployment assistance need

English Proficiency

BIO

Jess is a current undergraduate student at UW. She is studying engineering while working part-time. Jess likes to spend time with friends and family. She enjoys the outdoors, cooking, reading, and watching movies. At the start of COVID-19, Jess was furloughed. Her experience with the WA unemployment site was frustrating and confusing. It took her months to figure out whether she was actually eligible and to receive benefits. She felt the terminology and questions were ambiguous.

> "The language used is too ambiguous. The only reason I knew I qualified for unemployment was because my coworkers had received benefits already."

Ideal Experience

Speedy

Simple

Live assistance

Easy to understand

Goals

- Apply for and receive unemployment benefits quickly
- Ability to talk to a real person for help
- Clarity as to whether eligible or not
- Ability to fix questions easily when answered wrong

Frustrations

- No live help (phone or chatbot)
- Information overload and ambiguous wording
- Wasn't aware of the unemployment eligibility checker
- Applying for unemployment took months

Channels/Technology

Mobile

Website

Social Media

Email

Online shopping

Traits

Analytical

Social

Independent

Tech-savvy

Busy

Adventurous

Brand Influences

TRADER JOE'S

WHOLE FOODS MARKET

REI

HEATHER

38, Washington

Knowledge Manager

· STATUS

Married

1 child

· SALARY

$30/hr

PERSONALITY

Technology friendly

Unemployment assistance need

English Proficiency

BIO

Heather is a part time working mom, who was furloughed during the COVID19 pandemic.

During her unemployment timeline, she enjoyed spending quality time with her daughter.

Ideal Experience

Speedy

Simple

Live assistance

Easy to understand

Goals

- To identify whether she qualifies for unemployment assistance
- To receive unemployment benefits for supporting herself and her daughter
- To be able to receive assistance for ambiguous questions from the unemployment office

Frustrations

- Unemployment office froze her application, and asked to return the money
- The entire process was very time consuming
- The website kept crashing, and filling the form took 3 days
- Confusing and ambiguous questions

> "Some questions were confusing or made you second guess yourself - "were you willing and able to work? (is this meant to discourage applications or is it a genuine question)"

Channels/Technology

Mobile

Website

Social Media

Email

Online Shopping

Traits

Busy

Outgoing

Organized

Empathetic

Brand Influences

HIMARI

46, Seattle

Aquatic Therapist

· STATUS	· SALARY
Married	$80,00
1 Child	Genuine Foodie

PERSONALITY

Technology- friendly

Unemployment assistance need

English Proficiency

BIO

Unemployment has been difficult for Himari, as she is a single mother and speaks english as a second language. In addition, she was laid off quite unexpectedly after over a decade working there, so she felt very blindsided.

Thankfully, Himari has many native English speakers friends who were able to guide her to the correct forms and help understand if she is eligible for unemployment benefits.

Ideal Experience

Speedy

Language Translation

Live Assistance

Easy to Understand

Goals

- To receive unemployment benefits hassle free and as soon as possible
- To be able to provide for her daughter
- To be able to lead her life similar to how it was before the COVID19 pandemic

Frustrations

- The questionnaire was very lengthy and time consuming, and asked for information that could be accessed elsewhere.
- There was no way to translate the questionnaire to another language
- She was left without financial support while waiting for payments

> "I did not feel supported. The English was difficult to understand and I was constantly worried about how to provide for my daughter."

Channels

Mobile

Website

Email

Social Media

Online shopping

Traits

Anxious

Perfectionist

Impatient

Introvert

Brand Influences

Empathy Map

Think and feel?

- Worry whether answered questions correctly
- time consuming
- frustrated with unemployment site
- long wait to receive the payment
- I wish there was a live chat option
- I wish there was a Japanese translation
- lengthy questions
- impatient
- frustrated
- uncertainty
- Rent is due
- anxious

Hear?

- check if you're eligible when you're furloughed
- "You might be eligible"
- you'll hear back eventually
- "Just fill out the form"
- "we need more information"
- daughter needs things

See?

- cluttered site
- looking up the definition of a word doesnt help
- page to check eligibility
- only spanish translation available
- other employees getting payments
- website crashing

Say and do?

- "I don't understand"
- Try to find other work
- confusing and ambiguous questions
- Weekly claims
- ask native english speakers for help
- "don't they already have this information?"
- Call unemployment office for help

Pain

- no income
- need to pay for kids
- Difficulty to buy daily needs
- difficulty accessing the unemployment eligibility checker
- Uncertainty- when will this be over?

Gain

- No more work - more ability to relax
- more time with family
- unemployment payments

Storyboard

Unemployed
Visits the Washington state website to look for unemployment benefits
Creates profile
Opens eligibility checker application on mobile or desktop
Fills the questionnaire
Live chatbot for assistance
Gets an estimate of the amount to be received
Gets confirmation and status check in her account
Option to subscribe for notifications

Wireframes

WA Unemployment Benefits

https://esd.wa.gov/unemployment

Employment Security Department

Washington State

Translations

Quick Links:
- Eligibility Check
- Apply Now
- FAQs
- Chat
- Sign up for direct deposit

Affected by COVID-19
Lost Wages Assistance is a federal program that adds $300 for each week the program remains federally funded. If you receive unemployment benefits for certain weeks and you are unemployed or working fewer hours because of the COVID-19 pandemic, you may be eligible for these benefits.

The federal CARES Act expands unemployment benefits to people affected by COVID-19. If you are not eligible for regular unemployment, learn more about Pandemic Unemployment Assistance here:

Self-employed & Independent contractors

Sick or caring for a family member

Lost work or part time worker

START HERE: Create Account

Step 1: Check Eligibility

Click here to see our eligibility checklist and find out what benefits you qualify for

Eligibility Checklist

Step 2: Apply

Please gather the necessary documents
We suggest applying on a computer or desktop rather than a tablet or mobile device.

Apply

Step 3: After Applying
Click here to see when to expect your benefits to begin.
Sign up for direct deposit to get your check faster:

Direct Deposit

Live Chat Support

+

Create Account

Create User Account

Legal First name

Legal Last Name

Email address

Retype email

Username

Password

Retype Password

Preferred Language Choose

I am not a robot Confirm you are not a robot

Create Account

Employment Security Department

Washington State

Select Yes or No for the following questions

Yes	No	
☐	☐	Did you work at least 680 hours in the first four of the last five completed calendar quarters? What is a calendar quarter?
☐	☐	Did you work less than 680 hours in the last 18 months because of the COVID-19 public health emergency?
☐	☐	Did you work in Washington State sometime in the last 18 months?
☐	☐	Are you out of work due to the COVID 19 public health emergency?
☐	☐	Are you physically and mentally able to work?
☐	☐	Can you work remotely from home for your usual number of hours with pay during the COVID-19 health emergency?
☐	☐	Are you available for work?
☐	☐	Are you an independent contractor or self employed and has the COVID-19 public health emergency severely limited your ability to do regular work activities?
☐	☐	Were you laid off? Learn more about being laid off
☐	☐	Is your place of employment closed or operating at a reduced capacity due to the COVID-19 public health emergency?
☐	☐	Is COVID-19 preventing you from working at home or anywhere else because you are the main caregiver to a household member who requires constant, ongoing care (due to chronic illness or because schools and daycares are closed)
☐	☐	Are you unable to get to your place of employment due to quarantine imposed by state or municipal officials as a result of the COVID-19 emergency?
☐	☐	Did you quit your job? Learn more about quitting
☐	☐	If yes, was it a result of COVID-19?
☐	☐	Were you diagnosed with COVID-19?
☐	☐	Do you have symptoms of COVID-19 and are seeking a medical diagnosis?
☐	☐	Has someone in your household been diagnosed with COVID-19?
☐	☐	Are you providing constant and ongoing care for a household member who has COVID-19?
☐	☐	Did you become the breadwinner or major support for a household because the head of household died as a direct result of COVID-19?
☐	☐	Were you discharged from the military in the last 18 months?
☐	☐	If none of the following statements apply to you, select yes - I was fired and it was my fault - I am on strike from my employer - I am on a leave of absence from my job - I am still working

Live Chat Support

+

Employment Security Department

Washington State

Select Yes or No for the following questions

Yes	No	
☑	☐	Did you work at least 680 hours in the first four of the last five completed calendar quarters? What is a calendar quarter?
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☐	☑	Were you discharged from the military in the last 18 months?
☑	☐	If none of the following statements apply to you, select yes

- I was fired and it was my fault
- I am on strike from my employer
- I am on a leave of absence from my job
- I am still working

Results: You qualify for Pandemic Unemployment Assistance and regular unemployment assistance (up to $600/week)

Click here to begin application

Thank you!